我的中国朋友

你教我，我教你

My Chinese Friend

You teach me, I teach you

Text and translation by Claude (Anthropic)

Footnotes mark names and words above HSK 1 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 安娜[†]是法国[‡]人，今年二十岁。她在北京的一个大学学习汉语。她会说一点儿汉语，也会写一些汉字。她很喜欢北京。她有很多外国朋友，还没有中国朋友。

一个新朋友

2 星期三下午，安娜在图书馆看书。书里有一个字，她不认识。她旁边坐着一个男生。安娜问他："对不起，请问，这个字怎么读？"男生看了看，说："这是'飞'，飞机的'飞'。"

3 "谢谢！你是这儿的学生吗？""是。我叫李明[§]，我是北京人。你呢？""我叫安娜，我是法国人。"李明很高兴："你会说法语[¶]吗？"安娜笑了："我是法国人，我会说法语！"

† 安娜 *Ānnà* Anna
‡ 法国 *Fǎguó* France
§ 李明 *Lǐ Míng* Li Ming
¶ 法语 *Fǎyǔ* French (language)

Anna is French. She is twenty this year. She is studying Chinese at a university in Beijing. She can speak a little Chinese, and she can write some characters too. She likes Beijing very much. She has lots of foreign friends, but no Chinese friends yet. 1

A New Friend

On Wednesday afternoon Anna was reading in the library. There was a character in her book that she didn't know. A young man was sitting next to her. Anna asked him, "Excuse me, how do you read this character?" He took a look and said, "That's fēi, as in fēijī, 'aeroplane'." 2

"Thank you! Are you a student here?" "Yes. I'm Li Ming, and I'm from Beijing. What about you?" "I'm Anna. I'm French." Li Ming looked delighted. "Do you speak French?" Anna laughed. "I'm French, so yes, I speak French!" 3

4 李明[†]说：“我很想学法语[‡]。你能教我吗？”安娜[§]想了想，说：“能。你也能教我汉语吗？”“能！太好了！”他们说好，星期一、星期三、星期五的下午，都在图书馆见面。

你会说吗？

5 第一次上课，李明给安娜买了一杯茶。“这是茶。你会说吗？”“茶。”安娜说。“很好！”李明说。“茶，法语怎么说？”安娜说了一次。李明说了三次，都不对。他们两个人都笑了。

6 从那天起，他们常常一起学习。安娜很认真，天天写汉字。李明也很认真，在路上听法语，在车上也听法语。

7 有时候，李明问：“你累吗？”

† 李明 *Lǐ Míng* Li Ming
‡ 法语 *Fǎyǔ* French (language)
§ 安娜 *Ānnà* Anna

"I'd really like to learn French," said Li Ming. "Could you teach me?" Anna 4
thought for a moment and said, "Yes. And could you teach me Chinese too?"
"Yes! That's great!" They agreed to meet at the library every Monday, Wednesday and Friday afternoon.

Can You Say It?

At their first lesson, Li Ming bought Anna a cup of tea. "This is chá, tea. 5
Can you say it?" "Chá," said Anna. "Very good!" said Li Ming. "And how do you say 'tea' in French?" Anna said it once. Li Ming said it three times, and got it wrong every time. They both laughed.

From that day on they often studied together. Anna worked hard and wrote 6
characters every day. Li Ming worked hard too. He listened to French on his way to school, and on the bus as well.

Sometimes Li Ming would ask, "Are you tired?" 7

7 安娜[†]说：“不累。你呢？”“我也不累。法语[‡]很难，也很好听。”“汉语也很难，也很好听。”

我们都是老师

8 两个月后，李明[§]的一个同学问安娜：“你会说汉语吗？”安娜说：“会。我叫安娜，我是法国[¶]人，我在北京学习汉语。北京很大，我非常喜欢北京！”同学说：“你的汉语真好！谁是你的老师？”安娜说：“李明。”

9 李明站起来，用法语说：“我叫李明，我是中国人。安娜是我的好朋友。”同学听不明白，问：“你说的是什么？”安娜笑了：“他的法语也很好。他的老师是我！”

† 安娜 *Ānnà* Anna
‡ 法语 *Fǎyǔ* French (language)
§ 李明 *Lǐ Míng* Li Ming
¶ 法国 *Fǎguó* France

"No," Anna would say. "Are you?" "I'm not tired either. French is hard, and 7
it's beautiful too." "Chinese is hard too, and beautiful too."

We Are Both Teachers

Two months later, one of Li Ming's classmates asked Anna, "Can you speak 8
Chinese?" "Yes. My name is Anna, I'm French, and I'm studying Chinese in Beijing. Beijing is huge, and I love it!" "Your Chinese is really good!" said the classmate. "Who's your teacher?" "Li Ming," said Anna.

Li Ming stood up and said in French, "My name is Li Ming, and I'm Chi- 9
nese. Anna is my good friend." The classmate couldn't understand a word. "What did you just say?" Anna laughed. "His French is very good too. I'm his teacher!"

10 安娜[†]是学生，也是老师。李明[‡]是学生，也是老师。他们都是学生，也都是老师。最好的是，他们也是很好的朋友。

† 安娜 *Ānnà* Anna

‡ 李明 *Lǐ Míng* Li Ming

Anna is a student, and a teacher too. Li Ming is a student, and a teacher too. 10
They are both students, and both teachers. And best of all, they are very good friends as well.